the story of how i

HIT AN AXE ON MY OWN LEG

...and found my winning formula again



A LinkedIn playbook for Swapnil Agrawal · Oct 2026

chapter 1

THE GLORY DAYS

Jan to Mar 2026. I posted clinical carousels and the feed loved me.



THE HITS

BSSO
320 reactions · 8 comments

Dental Indices
264 reactions · 27 comments

Nerve Injury
168 reactions · 14 comments

All-on-4 implant
167 reactions · 11 comments

Endo Surgery
102 reactions · 6 comments

Every hit was a PDF carousel or a short animation.

chapter 2

THE AXE ON MY OWN LEG

WHAT I CHANGED (AND IT HURT):

- ✖ Swapped swipeable PDF carousels for 2 to 3 minute videos people skip in 3 seconds
- ✖ Swapped clinical fear topics for AI tools, apps & ebooks
- ✖ Put links right in the post, which LinkedIn quietly buries
- ✖ Ended with "what should I make next?" instead of an easy either/or
- ✖ Stuffed in up to 28 hashtags



chapter 3

THE LONG NAP

Between Mar 8 and Jul 31, 2026 I posted only once. LinkedIn forgets you fast when you stop showing up.



Lesson: a 4-month gap resets your reach. Then I came back with new formats AND new topics together, so the algorithm had to learn my audience from zero.

chapter 4

SHOUTING AT THE WRONG CROWD

My followers are dental students, PG aspirants and residents. They came for teeth, not tech.



THE FLOPS

Trauma Part 2
31 reactions

FPD claymation (3 min)
19 reactions

AI in Dentistry Pt 1
12 reactions

AI ebook
11 reactions

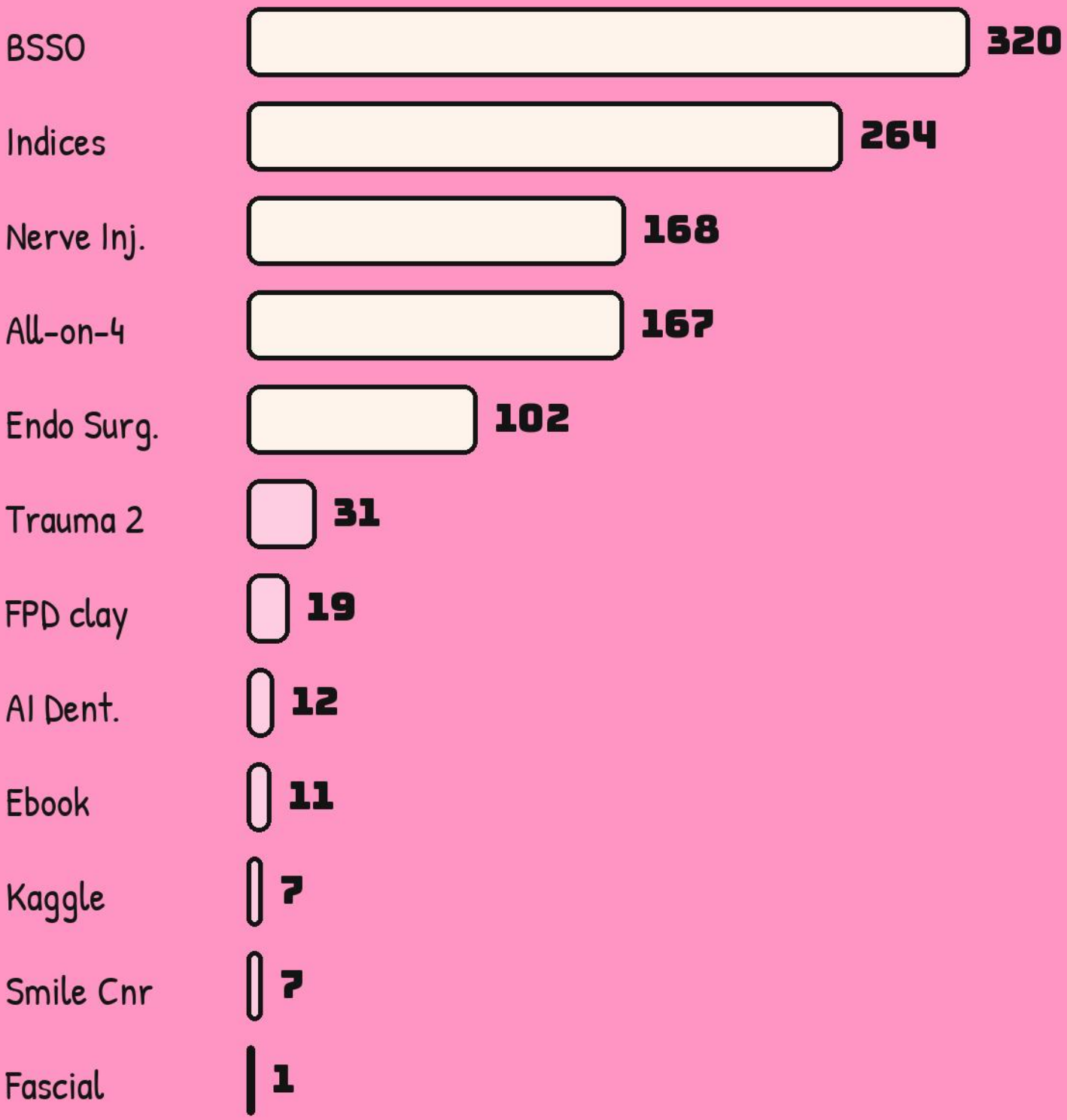
Kaggle caries app
7 reactions

Smile Corner + link
7 reactions

Fascial spaces video
1 reactions

the receipts

HITS VS FLOPS



Cream = Jan to Mar 2026 carousels & short animation. Light pink = Mar to Oct 2026 long videos, AI posts, links. Hashtags and posting time were NOT the difference: the hits went out at 1 to 2 am with 14 to 17 tags.

chapter 5

MY SECRET RECIPE



1 FEAR HOOK

Open with a clinical fear aimed at "you". "Your patient can't feel their lip at 6 months."

2 TEXTBOOK VS REALITY

"Textbooks lie by omission." Show what the syllabus skips.

3 RIGHT CROWD

Write for dental students, PG aspirants & residents.

4 PDF CAROUSEL

8 to 12 swipeable slides. Swipes = dwell time = reach.

5 EITHER/OR QUESTION

"OHI-S or CPITN?" got 27 comments, my best.

6 SAVE, SHARE, TAG

"Tag a surgeon who needs this."

7 ZERO LINKS

Links go in the first comment, never the post.

swipe file

HOOKS THAT HIT VS MISSED

THESE HIT

"Your patient can't feel their lip at 6 months post-extraction. You freeze."

"Your BSSO looks perfect in textbooks. Why did mine split wrong?"

"Memorizing indices is a nightmare."

"When RCT fails... surgery saves the day."

"I animated a dental implant explaining itself."

THESE MISSED

"Success begins with believing you can..."

"I created this 3-minute whiteboard explainer..."

"You loved Part 1... now here's the ADVANCED stuff"

"I turned my interest in AI into something tangible..."

copy-paste

THE POST TEMPLATE

[FEAR HOOK, under 10 words]
Your patient _____. You freeze.

[TEXTBOOK vs REALITY]
Textbooks teach _____.
Nobody teaches what to do when _____.

[5 ARROWS]
-> _____
-> _____
-> _____
-> _____
-> _____

[SAVE / TAG]
Save this for your viva. Tag a friend who mixes these up.

[EITHER / OR]
Which do you use more: _____ or _____?

#Dentistry #DentalStudent #BDS #NEETMDS #[topic]

(First comment: any link + "Part 2 drops Thursday")

chapter 6

THE COMEBACK PLAN

WEEK 1-4

3 PDF carousels a week (Tue · Thu · Sat), same pink doodle style.



VIDEOS

Under 60 seconds. A tooth or implant "talking", with captions on screen.

AI & APPS

At most 1 every 2 weeks, framed as "I built this to fix a dental problem."

FIRST HOUR

Reply to every comment with a question back.

DAILY

15 min commenting on dental educators' posts.

NEXT 8 CAROUSEL TOPICS

- Dry socket vs normal healing
- Oroantral communication: day-0 plan
- Syncope in the dental chair
- CPI vs CPITN traps
- LA failure in a hot pulp
- Ludwig's angina red flags
- Broken file during RCT
- NEET MDS MCQ traps: Prostho